Reading it on an iPad and a Mac: what works, what cannot, and the half-hour that fixes it

Short version: the links do not work across devices because they are *file* links, and a file link points at a folder on one machine. On an iPad they do not work even on that machine, because Safari refuses to open a local file from inside another local file. The fix is to put the folder online once. After that the same tracker and the same links work on every device you own, including the iPad.

Why it fails now

Situation	Does a link work?	Why
Mac, every file in one folder, opened in Chrome or Firefox	**Yes**	A relative link resolves beside the tracker
Mac, files in different folders	No	Nothing is beside the tracker to find
Mac, Safari	Often no	Safari restricts what a local page may open
iPad, files in iCloud Drive, opened in Files or Safari	**No**	iOS gives the page no access to neighbouring files at all
Any device, folder hosted on the web	**Yes**	An `https://` address means the same thing everywhere

So hosting is not a nicety here; on an iPad it is the only route that works.

Route A — GitHub Pages, about half an hour, free and permanent

This is the one I would choose. It gives stable addresses, costs nothing, works on every device, and needs no app.

1. Create a free account at github.com, then click **New repository**. Name it `me-module`, make it **Public**, and create it.

2. On the repository page choose **Add file → Upload files**. Drag in all 24 files. For the data, make a folder first: in the upload box type `me-problem-data/` in the file-name field before dropping the seven CSV and JSON files, or simply drag the whole `me-problem-data` folder in — GitHub keeps the folder name. Commit.

3. Go to **Settings → Pages**. Under "Build and deployment" set **Source** to "Deploy from a branch", **Branch** to `main` and the folder to `/ (root)`. Save. Wait two or three minutes.

4. Your folder is now at `https://YOURNAME.github.io/me-module/`. Check it by opening `https://YOURNAME.github.io/me-module/00-INDEX-me-module.pdf` in any browser.

5. Open the tracker at `https://YOURNAME.github.io/me-module/me-tracker-wk01-66-enhanced.html` — bookmark that on both devices. Because the tracker is now served from the same folder as everything else, **the links already work and you do not need to set anything**. If you prefer to keep a local copy of the tracker, open its **Materials** tab, paste `https://YOURNAME.github.io/me-module/` into the folder box, press **Save folder**, then **Test a link**.

A public repository means anyone with the address can read the files. Everything here is your own study material, so that is usually fine. If you would rather it were not public, route B avoids it.

Route B — iCloud Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive, about ten minutes

Quicker to set up and less tidy, because these services do not serve a folder as plain web addresses.

- Put the whole folder in iCloud Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive and let it sync to both devices.
- **On the Mac** this works like any local folder: open the tracker in Chrome or Firefox (not Safari) and the relative links resolve.
- **On the iPad** the links will still not work, because iOS isolates each file. What you can do is open the tracker for ticking and planning, and open the PDFs directly from the Files app when you want to read one. You lose the one-click route from a week to its chapter, which is the part that made the integration worth doing.
- Dropbox and OneDrive can give a direct link per file, and you could paste a base address into the Materials box — but their link format differs per file, so a single folder address will not work. Treat this as the fallback, not the plan.

Route C — a local web server on the Mac, five minutes, for the Mac only

If you only want the Mac fixed today: open Terminal in the module folder and run

```
cd ~/Downloads/me-module
python3 -m http.server 8000
```

then open `http://localhost:8000/me-tracker-wk01-66-enhanced.html`. Every link works, because the page is now served over http. The iPad can reach it too — at `http://YOUR-MACS-IP:8000/…` — but only while the Mac is awake and on the same network, which is why route A is better.

The one thing hosting does not fix: progress

Your ticks, hours, quiz history and notes are stored by the browser, per device. The iPad and the Mac will each keep their own, and hosting does not change that — a web page cannot write to a shared file.

The tracker already has the fix at the foot of every page: **Export backup** writes a small file with your whole state, and **Import backup** reads it. The habit that works:

When	Do this
Finishing a session on one device	Export backup, save it to the shared folder
Starting on the other device	Import backup from that file
If you forget and tick on both	Keep the more complete export and re-import it; the other device's ticks for that period are lost

If that is too much friction, the honest alternative is to **tick on one device only** — the Mac, say — and treat the iPad as a reading device. You lose nothing except the tick, and the tick is the part you can redo in ten seconds.

Checklist

	Check
1	All 24 files in one folder, with the seven data files inside `me-problem-data/`
2	Folder uploaded and Pages enabled; `00-INDEX-me-module.pdf` opens at its web address
3	Tracker opens at its web address on both devices and is bookmarked
4	Materials tab → **Test a link** opens the index
5	A week's module pointer and a problem link both open their file
6	You know where the exported backup lives

If a link still fails after hosting, the cause is almost always a file name: GitHub is case-sensitive, so `ME-Module-wk01-10-part01.pdf` is a different file from `me-module-wk01-10-part01.pdf`. Compare the failing address with the file list on the Materials tab.